

THE 5 STEEL WHEELS OF SAFETY



The world's fourth-largest rail transporter needs to balance both the safety and loading aspects as it targets a substantial increase in passenger and freight carriage year-on-year



Allocation of blocks—brief suspension of railway operations during a maintenance activity—needs to be prioritised across the Indian Railways network by the operations department



Adoption of new technologies such as artificial intelligence and machine learning for enhanced predictive maintenance



Homogeneity needs to be maintained in not only different technologies imbibed by the railways but also safety procedures followed across 19 railway zones



Create an enabling ecosystem to boost both 'Make in India' and 'Maintain in India'

SOURCE: INDUSTRY, BT RESEARCH

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RAILWAYS

SAFETY FIRST

As the country's economic backbone, the Indian Railways needs to implement not only 'Make in India' but also 'Maintain in India' to enhance safety

BY MANISH PANT

► **A REPORT BY** the Commissioner of Railway Safety (CRS) for the South Eastern Circle of the Indian Railways blames technical lapses in signalling for the triple train accident on June 2. But experts say that the report fails to clearly identify the underlying causes to prevent a recurrence. The accident in Odisha's Balasore district left 295 dead and over 1,200 injured. Incidentally, it bears an eerie similarity to the 1999 Gaisal train accident in West Bengal, where two passenger

trains collided, killing around 300 passengers, again due to a signalling error. "There are specific issues that successive railway inquiries have failed to capture," warns safety expert Lalit Chandra Trivedi, who retired as General Manager of East Central Railway.

A railway system has two components comprising fixed and rolling stock infrastructure. The fixed infrastructure—including stations, signalling, track and overhead electrical

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